

Only Miller Not Satisfied With No-hitter in Opening Game

By **BOB BELBE**
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

INDIANAPOLIS, Ind. — Stu Miller is a perfectionist.

The only person who could find any fault with his six-inning no-hitter that got Minneapolis off to a winning 1-0 start over Indianapolis here Tuesday night was Stu Miller himself.

"I wasn't satisfied with my control," he declared after the umpires had called a halt to the moist American Association curtain raiser.

"I was behind on too many hitters again and I lost my slow curve early. But I'll take one this way. No, I never pitched a nine-inning no-hitter. Had several for six and twice when play was resumed after rain I had to settle for one-hitters."

"I could have gone nine? I think so, although the arm was tightening up a bit. It was pretty wet out there."

Others had nothing but

praise for Miller's brilliant opening feat performed under the most adverse of conditions. The game started in a misting rain, braved by 3,347 cash customers, and the mist developed into a steady drizzle which finally ended the affair after a 50-minute delay.

Only two Indians reached first. Ted Beard walked in the first and Don Prohovich in the fifth. Miller fanned seven.

"It's a pleasure to catch a pitcher like Stu," said Jake Jenkins. "He's got a

purpose for every pitch and how he can hit those spots."

Manager Red Davis marveled at his little right-hander's artistic performance and pointed out: "The only ball they hit good in the whole six innings was Jim Deising's long fly to center in the fifth. We missed some chances against that hard-throwing kid (Barry Latman, Indianapolis pitcher) but I think our lineup will get some runs. We're better hitters than we showed tonight."

The only run of the game

came when Carlos Paula poled a long double to left center to score the walking Wayne Terwilliger in the first inning.

In the third with the bases filled and none out the 20-year-old Latman fanned Hank Thompson and Paula on six pitches and got out of the inning when Vin Garcia came up with Orlando Cepeda's blistering smash.

Indianapolis Manager Andy Cohen had something to say about that.

"That Barry did a good

job," said Andrew. "He hung a curve to Paula and it was the ball game. He knows his mistake. He pitched good enough to win but we couldn't do anything with Miller. The boys were swinging too hard; they were meat for Miller's type. You've got to give him credit, though. He knows what he's doing."

Latman said he fired six straight fast balls to fan Thompson and Paula in the third. "I'll say this," he observed. "No one cheats those guys out of any

swings. I'm glad they missed."

Last night's victory, of course, will not go down in the record books as a no-hit game and it isn't the first six-inning no-hitter a Minneapolis pitcher has hurled. Back before World War II Mucky Haeferner performed the feat in a game that was ended by the old 6 p.m. Sunday law.

The closest to an opening Miller no-hitter within easy memory was Merv Grissom's one-hit game against Milwaukee in the Nicolet park curtain raiser of 1947.



STU MILLER